Vlad Bondarenko

QA Automation Engineer | SDET | Software Verification | AI Agent Testing

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QA automation and software verification engineer with 6+ years of experience testing regulated software: ophthalmic surgical devices at Bausch + Lomb, mortgage lending platforms at U.S. Bank, and healthcare systems at Express Scripts and Centene. Builds end-to-end automation from scratch (Cypress, Selenium, Ranorex) and applies the same test discipline to AI agents: built a Claude-powered browser agent, measured where it misreported its own results, and enforced its safety limits in code. Completing an A.A.S. in Cybersecurity.

Technical Skills

Test automation: Cypress, Selenium, Cucumber (BDD), Ranorex, Karate DSL, Postman, Python unittest

Languages: JavaScript, Python, Java, C#, SQL; mobile work in Kotlin, Swift and Objective-C

AI and agents: Claude Code, LLM agent tooling, agent evaluation and failure analysis, guardrails, prompt design

Tools: Jenkins, Docker, Git, AWS, Cloud Foundry, Node.js, Flask, JIRA, Zephyr, IBM Rational RequisitePro

Domains and methods: FDA-regulated medical devices, HIPAA, mortgage lending, WCAG; TDD, BDD, Agile; regression, integration, end-to-end, UAT and hardware testing

AI Agent and Automation Projects (2026)

Take the Wheel: AI browser agent

AI-assisted personal project • Claude Code, JavaScript, Node.js, Chrome extension • GitHub repository

- Built a Chrome side panel and Node.js runner that let Claude drive a live browser tab, with streamed step events, resumable sessions and a stop control.
- Enforced safety limits in code, not prompts: command allowlist, isolated workspace, token-authenticated local runner, budget and turn caps, and a submit lock that opens only when the user's task asks for it.
- Tested the agent as a system under test: caught a false-completion defect (reported 25 of 25 done; 23 verified), then redesigned page reading to reach a verified 25 of 25 in 5 turns instead of 29, at one-sixth of the cost.

Market Terminal: market data pipeline and dashboard

AI-assisted personal project • Python, SQLite, Flask • GitHub repository

- Built a Python pipeline that collects market data from nine sources, stores every raw response (SHA-256 deduplicated) and renders dashboards, reports and a Flask API from one immutable snapshot per run.
- Designed for testability: offline replay of any run, explicit “missing” states instead of placeholder values, and 32 offline unit tests covering idempotent imports, credential safety, bounded retries and parser failures.

Experience

Software Verification Engineer – Research & Development

Bausch + Lomb (contract) | St. Louis, MO | Mar 2026–Present

- Author verification protocols and dry-run procedures for FDA-regulated ophthalmic surgical systems (a next-generation platform and Stellaris), covering software, hardware integration and requirements testing.
- Audited legacy firmware protocols against resolved UI defects; retired obsolete requirements and removed dozens of invalid test cases before migration into IBM Rational RequisitePro.
- Isolated DMS configurations so verification can run remotely, reducing dependence on physical lab access.

Career Break: Full-Time Cybersecurity Studies

St. Louis Community College | Nov 2022–Mar 2026

- Studied cybersecurity full time toward an A.A.S. (in progress): ethical hacking, network defense, secure software design and CompTIA Security+ preparation; managed a personal investment portfolio.

Business Technology Analyst (QA Analyst)

U.S. Bank (contract) | St. Louis, MO | Oct 2019–Nov 2022

- Planned and ran end-to-end, integration and regression testing across the Black Knight, Seller Digital and Empower mortgage platforms (Conventional, FHA, VA and HFA loans).
- Turned BRDs, FRDs and user stories into test plans and test cases in JIRA and Zephyr; owned scope, timelines, defect management and go/no-go input for multiple initiatives.
- Maintained critical test data (Fannie Mae casefile IDs, Freddie Mac key IDs, credit reports, XML artifacts) so environments stayed accurate and audit-ready.
- Mentored and onboarded QA testers; wrote defect tickets with root-cause detail and supported post-production triage.

QA Automation Engineer

Centene Corporation | St. Louis, MO | Oct 2018–Apr 2019

- Built UAT and end-to-end automated test scripts from scratch with Ranorex (C#) and Cypress (JavaScript).
- Helped establish a CI/CD pipeline in a TDD team; contributed to solution design in JavaScript, Java and C#.

QA Automation Engineer II

Multiply / Answers.com (contract) | St. Louis, MO | Jul 2018–Sep 2018

- Wrote the test plan and built a Cypress and JavaScript end-to-end suite from scratch for a WordPress platform, cutting manual regression effort by about 50%.
- Validated back-end data with SQL, tested WCAG accessibility and maintained a Docker-based QA environment.

QA Engineer

Express Scripts via WWT Asynchrony (contract) | St. Louis, MO | Nov 2017–Jul 2018

- Tested a prescription portal handling PII and PHI against HIPAA requirements; automated unit, API and end-to-end tests with Selenium, Cucumber, Java and Postman.
- Worked with Jenkins, AWS and Cloud Foundry; completed WWT Asynchrony's Agile and TDD certification.

Mobile Cloud Developer Co-op

Emerson | St. Louis, MO | Dec 2016–Nov 2017 (began as Sensi Customer Advocate, May–Dec 2016)

- Developed Android and iOS features for the Sensi smart Wi-Fi thermostat apps (Java, Kotlin, Swift, Objective-C) using pair programming and TDD; wrote unit and user-acceptance tests.
- Ran exploratory hardware and software testing on the thermostat ahead of its public launch; integrated Salesforce SOS live-agent video support for 100,000+ app users.

Education

A.A.S., Cybersecurity (in progress): St. Louis Community College, 2022–Present

Associate Degree in General Education: St. Louis Community College Meramec, 2016–2018 • GPA 3.8, Honor Society